Civil War and Household Structure: Evidence from Burundi♣

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December 2025

PRELIMINARY DRAFT

Abstract

This paper analyzes whether civil war impacts household structure via individual migration. The identification strategy uses a unique two-wave longitudinal data set from Burundi, for 1997 and 2008, and was collected during ongoing conflict and allows tracking individual migration decisions over ten years. Besides traditional village-level conflict exposure measures, our data gather yearly information on household victimization. Results show that higher exposure to violence increases the probability of individual adult and child migration. Results are consistent using aggregated measures of conflict exposure or household-level victimization measures. While village-level violence does not impact marital migration for unmarried women, household victimization does. Being the victim of asset-related losses increases marital migration for unmarried women, implying the use of marriage markets as a strategy to face liquidity constraints. Results are robust to including province-specific time trends, alternative conflict exposure measures, and alternative levels of aggregation.

Keywords: household division, income diversification, civil war
JEL-codes: D13, J12, O12

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1. Introduction

Whereas much attention has been devoted to forced migration during civil war, extraordinarily little is known about other types of individual migration such as marital and non-marital migration in such a context. Civil wars not only cause deaths and injuries that persist long after the fighting has ended, but also force large-scale population displacement, disrupt livelihoods, damage infrastructure and economic growth, and weaken social capital and political institutions (Arias et al., 2019; Mercier et al., 2020; Vesco et al., 2025).

By modifying the political, economic and social environment, civil war generates uncertainty on local markets in which households operate (Blattman & Miguel, 2010). Households therefore recur to different strategies in order to protect themselves from victimization and to smooth household consumption (Bellows & Miguel, 2009; Engel & Ibáñez, 2007; Verwimp, 2003). Households revert to subsistence agriculture and shift a profitable to a less risky portfolio, as well as seek to off-farm alternative income sources that help them to mitigate the distortion on household welfare imposed by civil war (Brück et al., 2019; Collier, 1999; Deininger, 2003; Morduch, 1995; Nielsen & Verwimp, 2010). Among the different strategies, sending out household members to work out-side the household may smooth household consumption by transferring resources from migrants to the original household (Fagen & Bump, 2006).

Fafchamps & Quisumbing (2007) distinguish forces that keep households together and forces pushing households to divide. On the first, rural households could benefit from keeping all members together because of labor specialization among household members (Singh et al., 1986; Binswanger & McIntire, 1987). On the second, households could realize gains from risk-sharing through spatial diversification, choosing household members location and occupation to insure

against spatially covariant shocks. Rosenzweig and Stark (1989) found that Indian farm households with more variable plots tend to engage in longer distance marriage-cum-migration. In contrast, wealthier families, which are better able to self-insure, are less likely to engage in such long-distance insurance schemes. Migrant family members who have not established independent households are also likely to have regular salaries or incomes that are not highly covariant with their household of origin.

In contexts of economic vulnerability or conflict, men's and women's migration and employment decisions respond to differentiated family pressures and structural threats. In the Philippines, the family's short-run need for a stable source of income motivates unmarried female migrants to seek wage-earning jobs, despite their lack of long-term stability, since parents expect remittances to decrease after daughters marry and have their own familial obligations (Lauby & Stark, 1988). In situations of armed conflict, female employment tends to increase relative to male employment, driven by the relocation of informal workers from rural areas to safer urban centers where domestic services predominate (Bozzoli et al., 2013). In contrast, young men face greater risks of forced mobilization by the military or armed groups (Vesco et al., 2025). These gender-specific disruptions hinder structural transformations in the labor market and have persistent effects on household well-being.

The perception of a security threat can be sufficient to motivate displacement, even in the absence of direct victimization and regardless of the actor responsible for the threat (Hagen-Zanker et al., 2024). Fear and perceived insecurity alter the perceived balance of costs and benefits, making remaining in one's place of origin appear riskier than migrating—potentially affecting household composition and dynamics (Schon, 2019).

The purpose of this paper is to analysis whether civil war modifies household structure via the channel of individual migration. We use a unique longitudinal data set for Burundi for 1997 and 2008. Besides the traditional household roster information, this panel allows tracking individual migration decisions over ten years on a yearly basis, as well as detailed information on violence exposure and victimization measures. Thereby, using a within estimator, we are able to estimate how our aggregate measure of exposure to violence and direct victimization may modify the individual decision of marital and non-marital migration.

The contribution of our paper is threefold. First, due to our unique household panel, we provide empirical evidence on intra-household decision making during an ongoing conflict. Second, because of the rich information gathered on household victimization, we are able to distinguish between the effect of aggregated exposure to violence at village level and the actual victimization at the household level. Third, this paper contributes to the migration literature by providing robust estimations on the use of individual migration as a potential risk coping strategy.

Our findings show that an increase in the exposure and intensity of civil war increases the probability of household fragmentation by sending out household members for non-marital reasons. These effects are particularly strong for poor households and for adult male household members. Our results are confirmed with aggregated conflict exposure, as well as with household level victimization. Furthermore, we find that whereas marital migration is unaffected by aggregated violence, it is affected by direct victimization. In particular, we find that middle-aged female household members (15-45 years old), are more likely to experience marital migration as a result of asset losses at the household level.

The structure of the paper is as follows. Section 2 briefly discusses the recent history of civil war and migration in Burundi. Section 3 introduces the data and the basic descriptive

statistics. Section 4 describes the empirical identification strategy. The econometric results are discussed in Section 5. Section 6 concludes.

2. Civil War and Migration in Burundi

Decades of civil war and violence have had a profound impact on Burundi, hindering efforts to improve the living conditions of its population. Since gaining independence from Belgium in 1962, the country has been marked by a history of military repression and armed conflict that has consistently targeted the civilian population, with both the army and rebel groups treating civilians as strategic targets (World Bank, 2016).

This long civil war has been rooted in strong ethnic tensions between two groups: a minority Tutsi group historically related to power, and a majority of Hutu. After, the assassination of the first democratically elected Hutu President, Melchior Ndadaye, in October 1993 by Tutsi army elements, the country was engulfed in a civil war between the Tutsi-dominated military and various Hutu rebel groups. In a matter of weeks, 50,000 to 100,000 persons were murdered (UN, 1996). Several hundred thousand of Burundians fled the country to Tanzania to escape mass killing by the Tutsi-dominated army. According to the UNFPA (2004), 50% of the rural population were displaced at least once during the war.

After years of fighting, a Peace Agreement was signed in 2000, but it took several more years before the fighting really stopped. Despite negotiations, the population continued to face a low intensity conflict based on random acts of violence on a daily basis (e.g., blocking of roads, extortion, looting, among others). Rebel groups were very mobile between villages, communes, and provinces. The average household could not be sure that his or her village was safe from attacks by either the army looking for rebels or the rebels looking for food or booty. An attack could take place next week, next month or next year, or not at all. It created an environment of

increased risks and uncertainty. The 2000 Arusha Peace Agreement built the foundation for a peace process and a new constitution based on power sharing. Nonetheless, two Hutu rebel groups: The Conseil National de la Defense de la Democratie - Forces de la Defense de la Democratic (CNDD-FDD) of Pierre Nkurunziza, and the FNL lead by Agathon Rwasa; refused to sign such treaty, continuing their activities on the ground. The ethnic conflict had turned into a civil war opposing the transitional Burundian Government and the two Hutu rebel group (D'Aoust, 2015). The country therefore continued to be the scene of attacks. Both CNDD-FDD and FNL rebel groups finally accepted to lay down its weapons in 2005 and 2009, respectively.

Many transitory justice and social reintegration programs have taken place in Burundi since then. High uncertainty at local labor markets, high prevalence of rural poverty, among other factors triggered by a long civil war, made individual migration a widespread practice among Burundian households. Rural to rural, rural to urban as well as international migration started to be a pathway out of poverty. In the international context, for instance, Burundi's diaspora helps Burundians to find support and economic alternatives, in particular in Western Europe and Canada. Sons or daughters with an off-farm job can reduce the impact of uncertainty to the household via transfers to their parents (Fagen & Bump, 2006). Indeed, international and internal remittances have allowed members to support their families living in Burundi during civil war (Fransen & Ong'ayo, 2010; Uvin, 2009).

3. Data

We use a unique panel of household data for 1998 and 2007. In 1998, the World Bank and the Burundian Institute of Statistics and Economic Studies conducted a nationally representative household survey to analyze living standards, called 'the Household Priority Survey' (HPS 98, hereby). In total, 3908 rural households from 391 hills (*i.e.* the smallest administrative unit)

spread-out over the entire Burundian territory were interviewed (Republic of Burundi & World Bank, 1998). In 2007, a second survey was designed as a follow-up to HPS 98. Nonetheless, due to budget limitations, it was impossible to track and re-survey the entire original sample. Thereby, a sub-sample of 1000 households located at 100 randomly selected hills were chosen for tracking and re-surveying.[1]

During the follow-up survey, 87.4% of the original households randomly selected from HPS 98 were tracked and re-interviewed (i.e., 874 Households). The attrition rate of 12.6% is mainly explained by the following reasons: *(i)* all original household deceased (2.8%); *(ii)* household moved to another place, yet we were unable to find where (2.5%); *(iii)* the household disappeared all of a sudden and nobody knows its current whereabouts (2.4%); *(iv)* the household dissolved (3.6%); and/or, *(v)* we are unable to determine the reason for dropping out (1.3%). Whereas such attrition rate is common in well-known longitudinal studies in developing countries (e.g., Kenya Life Panel Survey 1998-2003/2005 (16%), Indonesia Family Life Survey (12%), among others), any subsequent analysis would be biased if drop out households were systematically different than those tracked households. In this sense, Verwimp and Bundervoet (2009) show that despite some slight differences on average age and gender of the household head, there is no systematic selection on poverty and exposure to violence.

In the second wave, a detailed set of retrospective questions on individual migration and victimization were included. Households were asked about the current situation of each household member who was present at HPS 98. In case any member left, specific follow up questions on month and year of migration, duration, reason he/she left and, if applicable, when

[1] Additionally, in the second wave were tracked and interview new households formed between 1998 and 2007 by members of the selected sample. For instance, if a son or daughter of a household that was interviewed in 1998 got married in the meantime and constituted his/her own household (between the two waves of the survey), this new household was tracked and surveyed (Verwimp & Bundervoet, 2009).

they returned were included. Multiple migratory movements by the same household member were also recorded. Based on this information, we are able to track the different individual migration decision over ten years, i.e., from 1998 to 2007 on a yearly basis. Furthermore, households were asked whether they were victims in a given year, between 1998 and 2007, of any of the following events: (i) theft of money; (ii) theft of crops; (iii) theft or destruction of goods; (iv) destruction of house; and, (v) loss of land.

Our baseline sample consists of household members present at HPS 98 that never migrate and those who had a non-marital migration. Initially, we disregard marital migration. Table 1 shows the summary statistics. We present both the cross-sectional as well as the longitudinal data structure for the various levels of information (i.e., individual, household and village or hill). Household members who died or arrive home after 1998 were omitted. In total, we have 3480 members who belong to the 872 selected households. 13.8% experienced at least one non-marital migration between 1997 and 2008. The main reason to migrate was insecurity (32.8%), followed by work (24.8%). For none of the interviewed households, we have an affirmative answer for recruitment or forced displacement.

Regarding the migration at household level, we found high heterogeneity. Around 28% of households had at least one person that left household between 1997 and 2008. On average, 1.79 members for each household ever left the household (standard deviations of 5.3). Moreover, 41 % of the households experienced theft of crops in a given year, and 24 % experienced theft or destruction of a good. When looking at the village level we find that 27% of the village experienced violence in a given year and, on average, the persistence of such exposure is highly heterogeneous among villages (mean 0.454 years and std. dev. 3.78).

Table 2 shows the comparison of means test for non-marital migration between villages that never were exposed to violence and those who did. We found that households living in conflict-affected villages have 5.24% more incidence of individual migration than their counterpart. Moreover, household members that migrate from a conflict-affected village took significantly more time outside the household (1.4 years more) than the migrants from a non-exposed village.

Yet is there any change on the economic profile between households that experienced non-marital individual migration and those who do not? Figure 1 shows the poverty mobility for household between 1998 and 2007, by having or not individual migration within the household[2]. In villages that experienced violence in at least one year (see Figure 1 (a)), we found that 31% of extreme poor households in 1998 that had at least one migration, managed to escape from extreme poverty. In contrast, only 21% of extreme poor households in 1998 without individual migration managed to escape from extreme poverty. For non-extreme poor households, on average, 56% of the households remained out poverty, regardless of having a member migrating. Now, for those villages that never experienced violence between 1998 and 2007 (see Figure 1 (b)), on average, 35 % of the extreme poor households in 1998 manage to escape poverty in 2007, regardless of having a member migrating.

4. Empirical Identification Strategy

The aim of the empirical analysis is to estimate the relationship between individual non-marital migration and civil war in Burundi. Our identification strategy relies on the detailed information on individual migration experience between 1998 and 2007 and the temporal variation of

[2] The poverty incidence in 1998 is based on the rural poverty line of Burundian Francs (BIF) 8,173.15. The poverty incidence in 2007 is based on the same poverty line but updated with product-specific 2007 prices. This updated 2007 poverty line amounts to BIF 16,560.64.

exposure to violence and household victimization in the same time span. We begin by estimating the following specification at the individual-year level:

$$Migration_{ijvt} = \alpha(Violence\ Exposure)_{vt} + c_i + \sum_{k=1999}^{2008} \theta_k dT_k + \boldsymbol{x_v'\delta} + u_{ijvt} \qquad (1)$$

the sub-index i refers to person who belongs to household j in village k at time t. Our main variable of interest is $(Violence\ Exposure)_{vt}$, which reports the violence exposure at the village level. In order to disentangle the effect of exposure and intensity of violence, we estimate two specifications with different violence indicators: *(i)* violence in a given year (yes=1)[3]; and *(ii)* number of causalities in a given year.[4] We expect that an increase in the level of exposure and/or intensity of civil war will trigger individual non-marital migration (i.e., $\alpha > 0$). Giving that the migration decision could vary among different individual characteristics, we replicate our baseline results by splitting our sample in three different sub-samples: *(a)* by gender (i.e., women/men); *(b)* by age group (adults/children); and *(c)* by poverty status in 1998.

Our data allow controlling for different potential unobservable characteristics. Firstly, c_i stands for time-invariant individual characteristics (e.g., motivation) that could be correlated with the migration experience, making some persons more prone to migrate. Secondly, we control for common shocks across years using year-fixed effect, $dT_k = 1\ \forall k = 1998, \ldots, 2007$. Thirdly, we include a province time-trend to control for any aggregated trend common at province level, $\boldsymbol{x_v'}$. Finally, we cluster our standard errors, u_{ijvt}, at village level.

Besides the exposure to violence at the village level, our data provides a rich set of victimization variables at household level. Thereby, we replicate our baseline analysis at

[3] Violence in a given year, takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, zero otherwise. Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100.

[4] Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100.

household level. As our dependent variable takes value one when at least one household member migrates for a non-marital reason in a giving year.[5] That is:

$$Migration_{jvt} = \alpha(Victimization)_{jvt} + c_j + \sum_{k=1999}^{2008} \theta_k dT_k + \boldsymbol{x_k'\delta} + u_{jvt} \qquad (2)$$

the sub-index *j* refers to household at village *k* at time *t*. We start by using the same village level violence indicators as in equation (1) (i.e., violence in a given year (yes=1) and the number of causalities in a given year). Then, we replicate our analysis using information on victimization at the household level, which measure whether the household was victim in a giving year of either: *(i)* Loss of land; *(ii)* Theft of crops; *(iii)* Theft of money; *(iv)* Theft or destruction of goods; and, *(v)* Destruction of house. Furthermore, based on those five measures, we built two aggregated indexes: *(i)* agricultural and *(ii)* assets related losses to capture covariant victimization.[6]

Our empirical analysis includes several extensions. First, we provide empirical evidence on marital migration and civil war. In developing countries, marital migration is a complex phenomenon that involves many household and individual dimensions (Fafchamps & Quisumbing, 2007). Evidence from conflict affected countries, suggests that women in marital age exposed to civil war may postpone their first marriage compared to other women of the same age (Shemyakina, 2013). To shed light on this topic, we provide results at the individual-year level for woman from three age groups (15-26, 15-35 and 15-45), as well as an aggregated household approach. Second, using information on household member that left home and then return before the follow up survey, we can provide evidence on return migration. Thereby, we replicate the individual-year and household-year approach to analyze how civil war is related to

[5] When using the total household members that migrate in a giving year, results are equivalents.
[6] *Index of Agricultural Related Losses* refers to the sum of *Loss of land (yes=1)* and *Theft of crops (yes=1)* for a household in a given year. *Index of Asset Related Losses* refers to the sum of *Theft of money (yes=1*), *Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1),* and *Destruction of house (yes=1)* for a household in a given year

the return decision. Under our main hypothesis, we expect that as conflict may trigger out-going migration, it would disincentives incoming migration.

5. Empirical Results

Our findings show that an increase in exposure and intensity of civil war increases the probability of household fragmentation by sending out some members of the household for non-marital reason. The observed effects are particularly strong for adult male members of poor household. Our results are consistent when using an aggregated measure of violence at the village level, as well as household level victimization measures.

5.1. Baseline Results: Non-marital Migration and Civil War

Table 3 presents our baseline regressions using year level information on individual migration from 1998 to 2007. Our dependent variable takes value one when a household member migrates outside the household in a given year. All specifications include individual and year fixed affect and province-specific time trends. We present seven specifications (columns) using different samples: *(i)* Baseline Sample (Column 1); *(ii)* Only women (Column 2); *(iii)* Only men (Column 3); *(iv)* Adults (older than 18 years old) (Column 4); *(v)* Children (younger than 18 years old) (Column 5); *(vi)* Poor households in 1998 (Column 6); and, *(vi)* Non-poor households in 1998 (Column 7). Moreover, we provide information on exposure and intensity of civil war. Whereas Panel A shows the results for exposure estimating the equation using Violence in a given year (yes=1), Panel B presents the point estimates for our intensity measure using the total number of causalities in a giving year.

Overall, our results confirm that civil war triggers household fragmentation by boosting individual migration. Living in conflict-affected villages in a giving year is correlated with an increase in the probability of migration outside the household with 3.1% points. Moreover, a one

standard deviation increases of the number of causalities in a giving year (i.e., 0.038), increase the likelihood to migrate with 0.9%. Results are robust and stable throughout the different samples. Although significant for both genders, the effect of civil war on individual migration seems to be stronger for men. This result may be explained by the fact that they are more likely to find job outside home. As expected, those household members that are adults (i.e., older than 18 years old) tend to migrate quicker as a result of increased violence in the village. Furthermore, poor households in 1998 exhibit a statistically significant and positive relationship between violence and individual migration. This effect may be explained by the increase of vulnerability of poor households in civil war, which may push them to look more intensively for other income sources (Justino, 2012).

Table 4 presents the results for the household level analysis (i.e., equation 2). Our dependent variable takes value one when at least one household member migrates outside household in a given year. Besides the two-village level conflict indicators (Columns 1 and 2), we include the five different household victimization indicators (Columns 3 to 7) as well as two indexes for agricultural related losses (land and/or crops) (Columns 8) and asset related losses (money, goods, and/or house) (Column 9).

For conflict exposure at village level, results are consistent with the individual year-approach both in signs and magnitudes. This confirms the statistically significant and positive relationship between exposure to conflict and individual migration within the household. Concerning the victimization measures, in general, we find that the asset related losses are the main trigger of individual migration, increasing the likelihood of individual migration with 4.1%. Indeed, being victim of destruction of the house or of goods in a given year is related to an

increase in the likelihood of individual migration with 7.8% and 5.9%, respectively. We found no effect for agricultural related losses.

5.2.Marital Migration and Civil War

Once we establish the relationship between non-marital migration and civil war, the following step is exploring whether this relationship holds for marital migration. Unlike most western societies, in many African countries, marriage is often a collective decision that involves entire household's interests. As parents usually transfer capital to children at the time of marriage, choosing the suitable partner for the daughter or son can be an occasion for a large transfer of wealth as a result of marriage (Fafchamps & Quisumbing, 2007). In Burundi, the groom's family usually transfers assets to the brides at marriage. After which, women usually leave home to move to their spouse's home.

We replicate our baseline analysis for marital migration. That is, we explore whether household members leaving due to marriage in a given year is related to exposure to violence. We focus on non-married women at marital age. Table 5 shows the individual-year approach. We use three different marital ages: (i) 15-25 years old (column 1); (ii) 15-35 years (column 2); and (iii) 15-45 years old (column 3). We found no statistically significant relationship between marital migration and civil war exposure in Burundi. This implies that aggregated exposure to violence is unrelated to marital decisions.

Table 6 shows the results for the household level analysis. We only consider households with at least one woman at marital age (*i.e.,* between 15 to 45 years old) in a given year. For simplicity, we only show the two measures of conflict exposure at the village level and the two indexed for the household victimization approach. As in our individual level analysis, we find no significant relationship using aggregated conflict exposure measures. Yet, we do find a

statistically significant relationship with the victimization measures. We found that being victim of at least one asset related loss (i.e., money, goods, and/or house), is related to an increase in marital migration of 1.5%.

Our results from table 6 could be due to the age group. Thereby, we replicate the analysis for the index of assets related losses (money, goods, and/or house) over different age groups from 15-20 till 15-65. Figure 2 shows the point estimates and their confidence intervals. In general, we find no difference for the marital migration decision between households with young women (i.e., younger than 30 years) that were exposed to violence and those who were not. However, we find that civil war has a stronger relationship with marital marriage when including women over 35 years old and older. This process to delay the entry into marriage due to conflict could be associated to disruptions in family ties and the regular way of life resulting from the exposure to conflict (Shemyakina, 2013).

5.3.Return Migration and Civil War

We now explore the relationship between returnee migrants and civil war. So far, we have showed that civil war triggers household division by boosting individual migration. Under this logic, we may also expect that household member who migrate at some point will have different incentives to return as a result of conflict exposure. We therefore study the return decision of those household members that were presents in 1998 and migrate for non-marital reasons at some point between 1998 and 2007. Table 7 presents the results using the individual level as well as the household level. Whereas we do not find any significant difference using the former, we do for the latter. In particular, we find that households residing in a conflict affected village or a victim of asset related losses, are less likely to have at least one migrated member who returned in a given year.

6. Conclusion

This paper analysis how civil conflict could modify household composition by boosting individual migration during Civil War. We analyze both marital and non-marital migration. We use a unique longitudinal data set for Burundi for 1998 and 2007, which allows tracking individual migration decisions and conflict exposure over ten years on a yearly basis. Our results suggest a statistically significant and positive relationship between exposure to conflict and individual migration within households. Our results are consistent with aggregated measure of violence as well as household level victimization measures. While no significant effect was found for marital migration and aggregate exposure to violence, we did find a statistically significant relationship with the victimization measures at the household level. In particular, we found that being victim of at least one asset related loss (i.e., money, goods, and/or house), is related to an increase of marital migration with 1.5%. When analyzing return migration decisions, we find similar patterns as marital migration. We find that households operating in a conflict affected village or victim of asset related losses, are less likely to have at least one migrated member who returned in a given year.

Understanding the specific mechanism through which civil war affects individual migration is critical for post-conflict countries adequate transitory policy in favor of households. While our data do not allow definitive conclusions, our results do offer some indications as to the mechanisms.

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TABLES AND FIGURES

Table 1. Summary statistics

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. Dev.
Individual-year level			
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	34800	0.077	0.267
Number of casualties in a given year	34800	0.005	0.038
Fraction of years when individual left the household	34800	0.045	0.207
Individual level			
Fraction of individuals that ever left the household	3480	0.138	0.345
Household-year level			
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	8720	0.078	0.268
Number of casualties in a given year	8720	0.004	0.037
At least 1 person left the household in a given year (yes=1)	8720	0.099	0.299
Average number of people leaving the household in a given year	8720	0.179	0.718
Theft of money (yes=1) for a household in a given year	8720	0.030	0.169
Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year	8720	0.069	0.254
Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1) for a household in a given year	8720	0.034	0.181
Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year	8720	0.014	0.117
Loss of land (yes=1) for a household in a given year	8720	0.015	0.121
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)	8720	0.084	0.287
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)	8720	0.078	0.344
Household level			
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	872	0.275	0.447
Number of casualties in a given year	872	0.016	0.054
Number of members of household that migrated outside household	872	1.792	5.321
Fraction of households with individual migration	872	0.279	0.449
Household ever experienced theft of money	872	0.209	0.407
Household ever experienced theft of crops	872	0.411	0.492
Household ever experienced theft or destruction of good	872	0.240	0.427
Household ever experienced destruction of house	872	0.103	0.304
Household ever experienced loss of land	872	0.107	0.309
Village-year level			
Fraction of years when village experienced violence	1000	0.005	0.038
Number of casualties in a given year	1000	0.076	0.265
Village level			
Fraction of villages that ever experienced violence at least one year during 1998-2007	100	0.270	0.446

Notes - This table presents the main descriptive statistics at different observation levels. *Violence in a given year (yes=1)* takes the value one if the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. *Number of casualties in a given year* measures the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year (divided by 100). *Index of Agricultural Related Losses* refers to the sum of *Loss of land (yes=1)* and *Theft of crops (yes=1)* for a household in a given year. *Index of Asset Related Losses* refers to the sum of *Theft of money (yes=1*), *Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1),* and *Destruction of house (yes=1)* for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 2: Migration by violence presence

	Villages that never experienced violence		Villages that experienced violence in at least 1 year during 1998-2007		
	Observations	Percentage	Observations	Percentage	Diff- Mean test
Migration	3180	12.520	1670	6.575	-5.246***
		[33.094]		[38.224]	(0.417)
No migration	22220		7730		
Total	25400		9400		
Duration of migration (in years)	0.906		2.370		-1.463***
	[1.109]		[1.809]		(0.053)

Notes - * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. Standard Deviation in brackets, Standard errors in parenthesis. Two-sided mean test reported. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 3. Baseline results. Civil War and Migration, Individual-level Analysis

Dependent Variable: Migration outside household in a given year (yes=1)	Baseline Sample	Only women	Only men	Adults (older than 18 years old)	Children (younger than 18 years old)	Poor Households (1998)	Non-Poor Households (1998)
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
Panel A							
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	0.031**	0.025*	0.036**	0.029**	0.025	0.036**	0.006
	[0.013]	[0.013]	[0.015]	[0.014]	[0.015]	[0.016]	[0.006]
Panel B							
Number of casualties in a given year	0.241***	0.277***	0.208**	0.192**	0.279**	0.241**	0.127***
	[0.090]	[0.104]	[0.080]	[0.088]	[0.108]	[0.092]	[0.048]
Observations	*34800*	*17880*	*16920*	*17828*	*16972*	*24910*	*9860*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.045*	*0.041*	*0.049*	*0.052*	*0.037*	*0.048*	*0.038*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table presents our baseline regression for individual migration. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. The dependent variable, *Migration outside of the household in a given year (yes=1)* takes value one when a person migrates due to non-marital reasons in a given year. *Column (1)* includes all household members that either never migrate or migrate for non-marital reasons during 1998-2007; household members who got married during this time period are omitted from the sample. *Columns (2) to (5)* restricts the baseline sample to only women, only men, only adults (older than 18 years old) or only young (younger than 18 years old), respectively. Columns (6) and (7) split the baseline sample defining poverty based on the average consumption per adult equivalent with respect to the rural poverty line of BIF 8,173.15. *Violence in a given year (presence=1)* takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. *Number of casualties in a given year* includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 4. Baseline results. Civil War and Migration, Household-level Analysis

Dependent Variable: At least one household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)
Conflict exposure, Village level									
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	0.038**								
	[0.016]								
Number of casualties in a given year		0.285***							
		[0.092]							
Conflict Exposure, Household level									
Loss of land (yes=1) for a household in a given year			-0.008						
			[0.022]						
Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year				0.006					
				[0.012]					
Theft of money (yes=1) for a household in a given year					0.059***				
					[0.020]				
Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1) for a household in a given year						0.057***			
						[0.021]			
Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year							0.078**		
							[0.031]		
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)								0.003	
								[0.011]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)									0.041***
									[0.011]
Observations	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*	*0.099*
Household Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table presents our baseline regression for household migration. Robust standard error, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. The dependent variable, at least one household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1), takes value one when at least one household member migrates due to no-marriage reason in a giving year. Violence in a given year (presence=1) takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100 people. Index of Agricultural Related Losses refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Index of Asset Related Losses refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1) and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 5. Civil War and Marital Migration, Individual-level Analysis

Dependent Variable: Left household due to marriage in a given year (yes=1)	Only adult non-married women (15-25)	Only adult non-married women (15-35)	Only adult non-married women (15-45)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel A			
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	-0.045	-0.039	-0.031
	[0.030]	[0.038]	[0.032]
Panel B			
Number of casualties in a given year	-0.144	-0.078	-0.072
	[0.190]	[0.161]	[0.143]
Observations	*2665*	*3069*	*3545*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.020*	*0.026*	*0.024*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table presents regressions for marital migration at the individual level. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. The dependent variable, "Left household due to marriage in a given year (yes=1)" takes value one when a woman got married and left the household in a given year. Column (1) restricts the baseline sample to those non-married women between 15 and 25 years old. Column (2) restricts the sample to those non-married women between 15 and 35 years old. Column (3) restricts the sample to those non-married women between 15 and 45 years old. Violence in a given year (presence=1) takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 6. Civil War and Marital Migration, Household-level Analysis

Dependent Variable: At least one woman got married and left the household in a given year (yes=1)	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Conflict exposure, Village level				
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	-0.026			
	[0.030]			
Number of casualties in a given year		-0.074		
		[0.167]		
Conflict Exposure, Household level				
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)			-0.011	
			[0.008]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)				0.015**
				[0.007]
Observations	2557	2557	2557	2557
Mean Dependent Variable	0.03	0.03	0.03	0.03
Household Fixed Effect	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Year Fixed Effect	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Province time-trend	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes - This table presents regression for marital migration at the household level. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. The dependent variable, at least one woman in the household leaves to get married in a given year (yes=1), takes value one when at least one woman migrates due to marriage in a given year. Sample includes all households with at least one non-married women of marital age (15 to 45 years old). Violence in a given year (presence=1) takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. Index of Agricultural Related Losses refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Index of Asset Related Losses refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1), and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Table 7. Civil War and Return Migration

	Individual Approach		*Household Approach*			
	Dependent Variable: Migrant returns home in a given year (yes =1)		*Dependent Variable:* At least one migrant returns home in a given year (yes =1)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Conflict exposure, Village level						
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	-0.059		-0.068			
	[0.067]		[0.067]			
Conflict exposure, Village level						
Number of casualties in a given year		-0.081		-0.340***		
		[0.116]		[0.090]		
Conflict Exposure, Household level						
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)					-0.001	
					[0.035]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)						-0.057**
						[0.026]
Observations	*3420*	*3420*	*1655*	*1655*	*1655*	*1655*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.437*	*0.437*	*0.374*	*0.374*	*0.374*	*0.374*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table estimates the impact of conflict on return migration at individual and household level. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. In column 1, the sample includes all household members that migrated and lived outside the household for non-marital reasons. In columns 2 -4, the sample includes all households that have at least one member who migrated and lived outside household for non-marital reasons. In Column 1, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if a migrant returned home in a given year (yes =1). In Columns 2 to 4, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least one migrant returned home in a given year. Violence in a given year (presence=1) takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. Number of casualties in a given year includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. Index of Agricultural Related Losses refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Index of Asset Related Losses refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1), and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Appendix Table 1: Civil War and Migration, Household Level Analysis, By Age

	Adults (older than 18 years old)				*Children (younger than 18 years old)*			
	Dependent Variable: At least one household member older than 18 years old migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)				*Dependent Variable:* At least one household member younger than 18 years old migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	0.040**				0.032*			
	[0.016]				[0.016]			
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Number of casualties in a given year		0.273***				0.313***		
		[0.091]				[0.106]		
Conflict Exposure, Household level								
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)			-0.002				0.017	
			[0.010]				[0.012]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)				0.041***				0.032***
				[0.010]				[0.01]
Observations	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*6774*	*6774*	*6774*	*6774*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.075*	*0.075*	*0.075*	*0.075*	*0.047*	*0.047*	*0.047*	*0.047*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table presents our baseline regression for household migration, by age. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. In columns 4-6, the sample includes all households that have at least one member younger than 18 years old in a giving year. In columns 1 to 3, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least one household member older than 18 years old migrates outside household in a giving year. In columns 4 to 6, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least one household member younger than 18 years old migrates outside household in a giving year. *Violence in a given year (presence=1)* takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. *Number of casualties in a given year* includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. Index of Agricultural Related Losses refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. *Index of Asset Related Losses* refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1), and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Appendix Table 2: Civil War and Migration, Household Level Analysis, By Gender

	Women				*Men*			
	Dependent Variable: At least one female household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)				*Dependent Variable:* At least one male household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	0.032**				0.034**			
	[0.014]				[0.014]			
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Number of casualties in a given year		0.255***				0.296***		
		[0.092]				[0.106]		
Conflict Exposure, Household level								
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)			0.007				0.011	
			[0.01]				[0.009]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)				0.028***				0.039***
				[0.009]				[0.010]
Observations	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*	*8720*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.056*	*0.056*	*0.056*	*0.056*	*0.070*	*0.070*	*0.070*	*0.070*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

Notes - This table presents our baseline regression for household migration, by gender. Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. In columns 1 to 3, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least one female household member migrates outside household in a giving year. In columns 4 to 6, the dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least male one household member migrates outside household in a giving year. *Violence in a given year (presence=1)* takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. *Number of casualties in a given year* includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. *Index of Agricultural Related Losses* refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. *Index of Asset Related Losses* refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1), and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

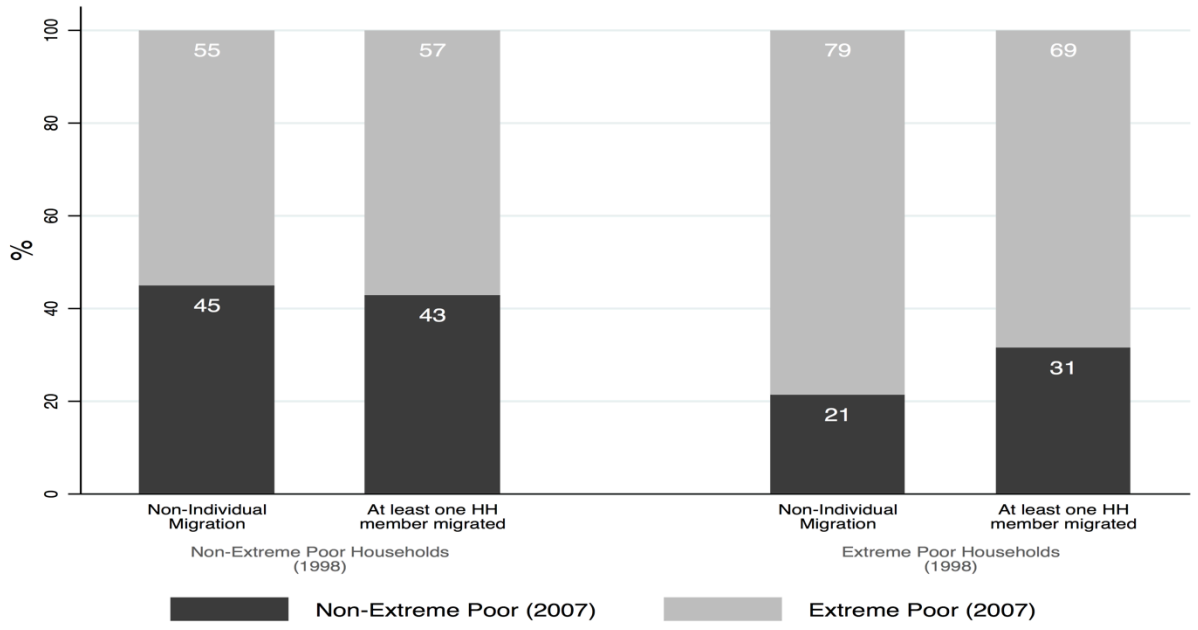
Appendix Table 3: Civil War and Migration, Household Level Analysis, By Poverty Status

	Non-Poor (1998)				*Poor (1998)*			
	Dependent Variable: At least one household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)				*Dependent Variable:* At least one household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1)			
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Violence in a given year (yes=1)	0.009				0.046**			
	[0.017]				[0.018]			
Conflict exposure, Village level								
Number of casualties in a given year		0.310**				0.281***		
		[0.122]				[0.099]		
Conflict Exposure, Household level								
Index of Agricultural Related Losses (land and/or crops)			-0.008				0.009	
			[0.016]				[0.013]	
Index of Asset Related Losses (money, goods, and/or house)				0.037*				0.042***
				[0.020]				[0.013]
Observations	*2720*	*2720*	*2720*	*2720*	*5970*	*5970*	*5970*	*5970*
Mean Dependent Variable	*0.029*	*0.029*	*0.029*	*0.029*	*0.071*	*0.071*	*0.071*	*0.071*
Individual Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Year Fixed Effect	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*
Province time-trend	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*	*Yes*

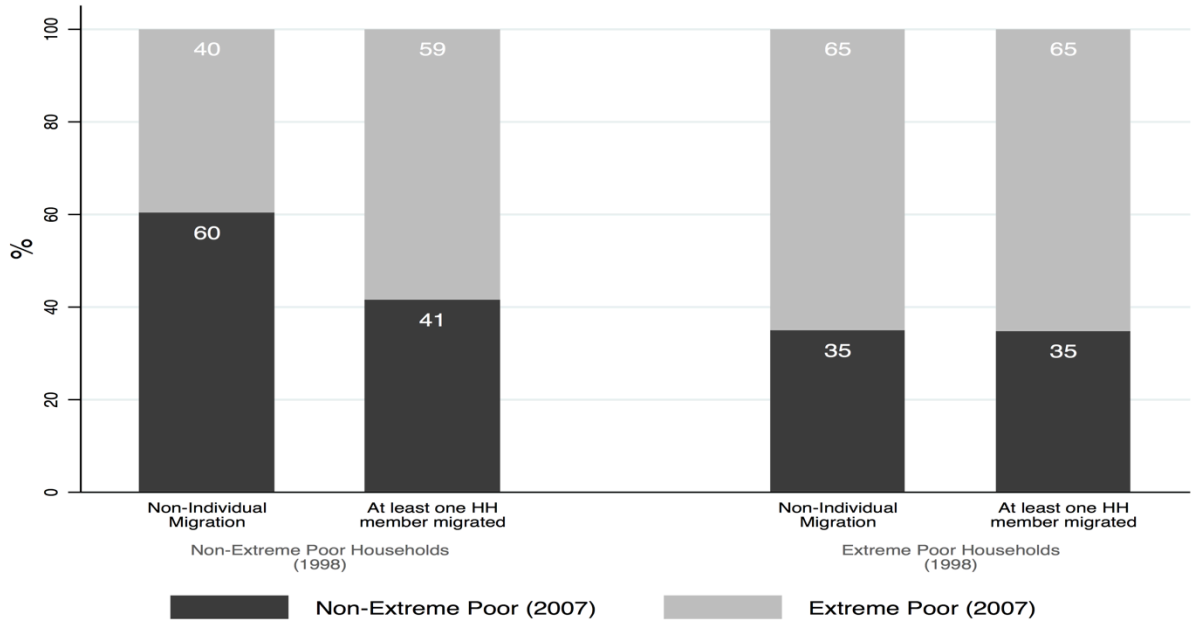
Notes - This table presents our baseline regression for household migration, by poor status (1998). Robust standard errors, clustered at Sous-Colline level. * p<0.10 ** p<0.05 *** p<0.01. In columns 1 to 3, the sample includes all non-poor households in 1998. In columns 4 to 6, the sample includes all poor households in 1998. Poverty incidence is based on the average consumption per adult equivalent with respect to the rural poverty line of BIF 8,173.15. The dependent variable is a dummy indicating if at least one household member migrates outside household in a given year (yes=1). *Violence in a given year (presence=1)* takes value one when the number of casualties in a given year is positive, 0 otherwise. *Number of casualties in a given year* includes the number of individuals killed or wounded in a given year, divided by 100. *Index of Agricultural Related Losses* refers to the sum of Loss of land (yes=1) and Theft of crops (yes=1) for a household in a given year. *Index of Asset Related Losses* refers to the sum of Theft of money (yes=1), Theft or destruction of goods (yes=1), and Destruction of house (yes=1) for a household in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Figure 1. Household transition on poor status between 1998 and 2007, by experience of migration.

(a) Villages that experienced violence in at least 1 year during 1998-2007

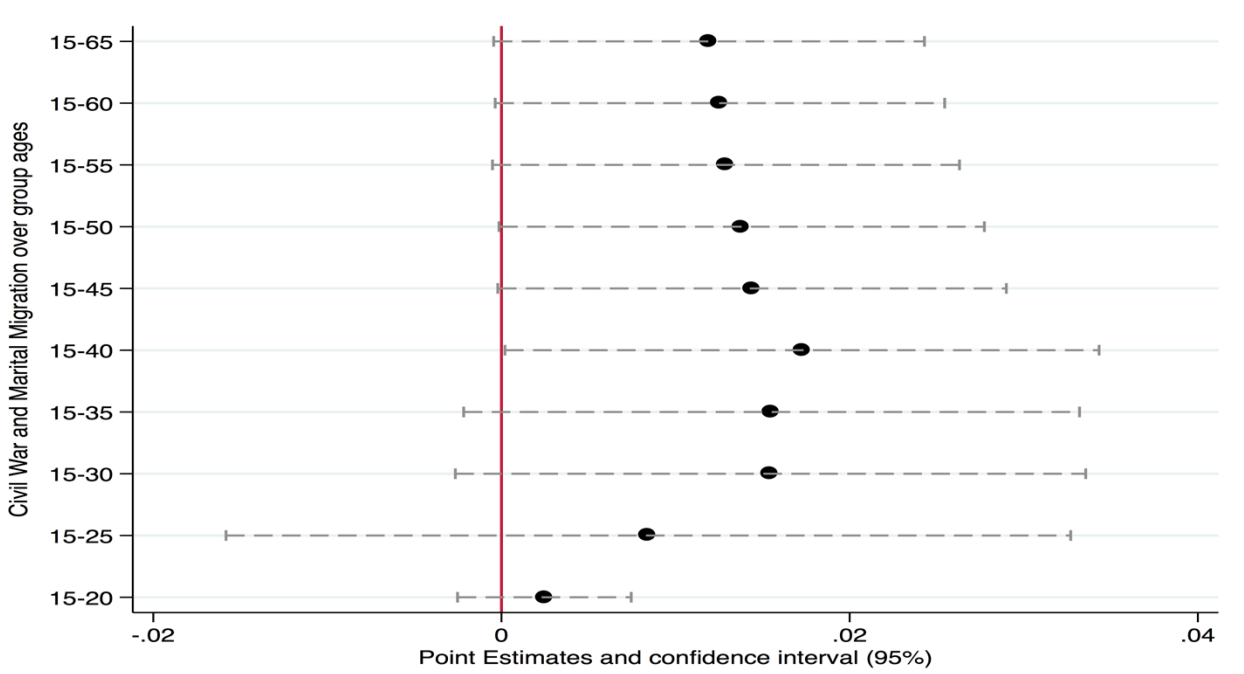


(b) Villages that never experienced violence



Notes – number of households= 871. The poverty incidence in 1998 is based on the rural poverty line of Burundian Francs (BIF) 8,173.15. The poverty incidence in 2007 is based on the same poverty line but updated with product-specific 2007 prices. This updated 2007 poverty line amounts to BIF 16,560.64. In 1998, the 68% were under the poverty line and 55.9% were extreme poor. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.

Figure 2. Civil war and marital migration over group ages.



Notes – This figure shows the point estimates for the household level analysis for marital migration and asset related losses index, that is: $Marriage_{jvt} = \alpha(Index\ of\ Asset\ Related\ Losses)_{jvt} + c_j + \sum_{k=1999}^{2008} \theta_k dT_k + \boldsymbol{x_k'\delta} + u_{jvt}$. In each equation, our dependent variable takes value one when at least one woman between each group age migrates due to marriage in a given year. Data source: 2007 Burundi Priority Panel Survey.